§ **181.** **e** (Anglian and Ken.) = (1) WS. **ie** after palatal **c, g, sc,** as **gefa(n)**, *to give*, **gelda(n)**, *to pay*, **sceld**, *shield*, WS. **giefan, gieldan, scield** (§ **91**).

= (2) WS. **ie, i**-umlaut of **ea** before **r** + consonant, as **derne**, *secret*, **erfe**, *inheritance*, WS. **dierne, ierfe** (§ **67**, Note).

= (3) WS. **ie, i**-umlaut of **ea**, after palatal **c, g, sc,** as **cele**, *cold*, **gest**, *guest*, **sceppan**, *to create*, WS. **ciele, giest, scieppan** (§ **73**, Note).

§ **182.** **e** (Anglian) = (1) WS. **eo** before **lc, lh,** as **elh**, *elk*, **melca(n)**, *to milk*, WS. **eolh, meolcan** (§ **84**).

= (2) WS. **eo** before **h, hs, ht,** as **feh**, *cattle*, **sex**, *six*, **cneht**, *boy*, early WS. **feoh, seox, cneoht** (§ **86**, Note).

= (3) WS. **eo** before **r** + guttural, as **derc**, *dark*, **werc**, *work*, **dwerg**, *dwarf*, **ferh**, *life*, WS. **deorc, weorc, dweorg, feorh** (§ **85**, Note 2).

§ **183.** **e** (Ken.) = (1) WS. **æ**, as **deg**, *day*, **feder**, *father*, **hefde**, *he had*, WS. **dæg, fæder, hæfde** (§ **54**, Note 1).

= (2) WS. **ea** after palatal **c, g, sc,** as **cester**, *city*, *fortress*, **get**, *gate*, **scel**, *shall*, WS. **ceaster, geat, sceal** (§ **72**, Note 1).

= (3) WS. **y, i**-umlaut of **u**, as **besig**, *busy*, **efel**, *evil*, **senn**, *sin*, WS. **bysig, yfel, synn** (§ **112**, Note 1).

= (4) WS. **ie, i**-umlaut of **ea**, as **eldra**, *older*, **eldu**, *old age*, WS. **ieldra, ieldu** (§ **65**, Note).

§ **184.** **i** (Anglian) = (1) WS. **ie** before a guttural or **r** + guttural, as **birce**, *birch*, **gebirhta(n)**, *to make bright*, **gesihþ**, *vision*, WS. **bierce, gebierhtan, gesiehþ** (§ **99**, Note 2).

= (2) WS. **io** (u-umlaut) before l + guttural, as **milc**, *milk*, WS. **mioluc, miolc** (§ **101**, Note 2).

= (3) WS. **io** (eo) before gutturals, as **getihhia(n)**, WS. **tiohhian, teohhian**, *to arrange, think, consider* (§ **98**, Note 2).

= (4) WS. **u** in the combination **wu-** before gutturals, as **betwih**, *between*, **cwic(u)**, *quick, alive*, **wicu**, *week*, WS. **betwuh, c(w)ucu, wucu** (§ **103**).

§ **185.** **o** (late Nth.) = late WS. **u** in the combination **wu-**, as **sword**, *sword*, **worþa**, *to become*, late WS. **swurd, wurþan** (§ **94**).

§ **186.** **œ** (Nth.) = (1) WS. **e**, **i**-umlaut of **o**, as dat. **dœhter**, *to a daughter*, **œle**, *oil*, WS. **dehter, ele** (§ **107**).

= (2) WS. **e** after **w**, as **cuœþa**, *to say*, **wœg**, *way*, WS. **cweþan, weg** (§ **80**, Note 1); **cuœlla**, *to kill*, WS. **cwellan** (§ **55**, Note 1).

§ **187.** **ǣ** (Anglian) later **ē** = WS. **ēa**, Germanic **au** before **c, g, h**, as **ǣc**, *also*, **hǣh**, *high*, **tǣg**, *rope*, later **ēc, hēh, tēg**, WS. **ēac, hēah, tēag** (§ **135**, Note 2).

§ **188.** **ē** (Anglian and Ken.) = (1) WS. **ǣ**, Germanic **ǣ**, as **bēron**, *they bore*, **dēd**, *deed*, **sēton**, *they sat*, **slēpan**, *to sleep*, WS. **bǣron, dǣd, sǣton, slǣpon** (§ **119**).

= (2) WS. **ēa** after palatal **c, g, sc**, as **cēce**, *jaw*, **gēr**, *year*, **gēfon**, *they gave*, **scēp**, *sheep*, WS. **cēace, gēar, gēafon, scēap** (§ **124**, Note).

= (3) WS. **īe**, **i**-umlaut of **ēa**, as **gelēfan**, *to believe*, **hēran**, *to hear*, **nēd**, *need*, WS. **gelīefan, hīeran, nīed** (§ **124**).

§ **189.** **ē** (Anglian) = (1) WS. **ēo**, Germanic **eu**, before

c, g, h, as rēca(n), *to smoke*, sēc, *sick*, flēga(n), *to fly*, lēht, *light*, WS. rēocan, sēoc, flēogan, lēoht (§ 137, Note 2).

= (2) WS. īe, i-umlaut of ēa from older ǣ by breaking, as *nēsta from nēhista, WS. nīehsta, *nearest, next* (§ 123).

= (3) older ǣ, see § 187.

§ 190. ē (Ken.) = Anglian and WS. ȳ, i-umlaut of ū, as hēf, *hive*, mēs, *mice*, ontēnan, *to open*, Anglian and WS. hȳf, mȳs, ontȳnan (§ 132, Note).

§ 191. ē (late Ken.) = Anglian and WS. ǣ, i-umlaut of ā, as clēne, *clean*, hēlan, *to heal*, hētan, *to heat*, Anglian and WS. clǣne, hǣlan, hǣtan (§ 134).

§ 192. ī (Anglian) = (1) WS. īo (ēo), Germanic ī before h and ht, as wīh, *idol*, līh, *lend thou*, līht, adj. *light*, WS. wēoh, lēoh, lēoht (§ 127).

= (2) WS. īe, i-umlaut of īo = Germanic iu, before c and ht, as cīcen, *chicken*, līhtan, *to give light*, WS. cīecen, līehtan (§ 138, Note).

= (3) WS. īe, i-umlaut of īo, Germanic ī, before ht, as līhtan, *to lighten, make easier* (§ 127).

§ 193. ī (Nth.) = WS. ieh, as sīs(t) from *sihis, *thou seest*, sīþ from *sihiþ, *he sees*, WS. siehst, siehþ (§ 99, Note 2).

§ 194. ǣ (Nth.) = (1) WS. ē, i-umlaut of ō of whatever origin, as bǣc, *books*, fǣt, *feet*, grǣne, *green*, WS. bēc, fēt, grēne (§ 129); gǣs, WS. gēs, *geese* (§ 62); fǣþ, WS. fēhþ, *he seizes* (§ 118).

= (2) WS. ǣ, Germanic ǣ, after w, as huǣr, *where*, wǣron, *they were*, WS. hwǣr, wǣron (§ 119, Note 2).

§ 195. **ea** (Anglian) beside **æ**, see § 179.

§ 196. **ea** (Nth.) = (1) WS. **eo** before **r** + consonant, as **earþe**, *earth*, **hearte**, *heart*, **stearra**, *star*, WS. **eorþe**, **heorte**, **steorra** (§ 85, Note 3).
= (2) WS. **e**, Mercian **eo** by **o/a**-umlaut, **beara**, **eata**, *to eat*, **treada**, *to tread*, WS. **beran**, **etan**, **tredan** (§ 93).

§ 197. **ea** (Mercian) by **u-**, **o/a**-umlaut = WS. **a**, as **featu**, *vats*, **heafuc**, *hawk*, **fearan**, *to go*, WS. **fatu**, **hafuc**, **faran** (§ 78).

§ 198. **eo** (Mercian and Ken.) by **u**-umlaut = WS. **e** (before all single consonants except labials and liquids), as **eodor**, *enclosure*, **eosol**, *donkey*, WS. **edor**, **esol** (§ 92).

§ 199. **eo** (Ken.) by **u**-umlaut = Anglian and WS. **e** before gutturals, as **breogo**, *prince*, **reogol**, *rule*, Anglian and WS. **brego**, **regol** (§ 92).

§ 200. **eo** (Mercian and Ken.) by **o/a**-umlaut = WS. **e**, as **beoran**, *to bear*, **eotan**, *to eat*, **feola**, *many*, WS. **beran**, **etan**, **fela** (§ 93).

§ 201. **eo** (Mercian and Ken.) = late WS. **u** in the combination **wu**, as **sweord**, *sword*, **sweostor**, *sister*, late WS. **swurd**, **swuster**(§ 94).

§ 202. **io** (Anglian and Ken.) by **u**-umlaut = WS. **i** (before all single consonants except labials and liquids), as **liomu**, *limbs*, **nioþor**, *lower*, **siodu**, *custom*, **sionu**, *sinew*, WS. **limu**, **niþor**, **sidu**, **sinu** (§ 101).

§ 203. **io** (Anglian and Ken.) by **o/a**-umlaut = WS. **i**, as **nioman**, *to take*, **niomaþ**, *they take*, WS. **niman**, **nimaþ** (§ 102).

§ 204. **io** (Nth. and Ken.) = WS. **ie**, **i**-umlaut of **io**, Germanic **i**, as **hiorde**, *shepherd*, **iorre**, *angry*, WS. **hierde**, **ierre** (§ 99, Note 1).

§ **205.** **io** (Ken.) = WS. **eo** by breaking before **r** + consonant, as **hiorte,** *heart,* **iorþe,** *earth,* **stiorra,** *star,* WS. **heorte, eorþe, steorra** (§ **85,** Note 3).

§ **206.** **io** (Ken.) by **o/a**-umlaut = Anglian and WS. **i** before gutturals, as **stiocian,** Anglian and WS. **stician,** *to prick* (§ **102**).

§ **207.** **io** (Mercian) beside **eo** = WS. **ie,** **i**-umlaut of **io,** as **iorre, eorre,** *angry,* **hiorde, heorde,** *shepherd,* WS. **ierre, hierde** (§ **99,** Note 1).

§ **208.** **ēa** (Nth.) = Mercian and WS. **ēo,** Germanic **eu,** as **dēap,** *deep,* **dēar,** *deer,* **lēaf,** *dear,* Mercian and WS. **dēop, dēor, lēof** (§ **137**).

§ **209.** **īo** (Ken.) beside **īa** = (1) Mercian and WS. **ēo,** Germanic **eu,** as **dīop (dīap), dīor, līof** = Mercian and WS. **dēop, dēor, lēof** (§ **137**).

= (2) WS. **īe,** **i**-umlaut of **īo,** Germanic **iu,** as **dīore (dīare),** *dear,* **līohtan,** *to give light,* WS. **dīere, līehtan** (§ **138**).

§ **210.** **īo** (Mercian) beside **ēo** = WS. **īe,** **i**-umlaut of **īo,** as **dīore (dēore), līohtan (lēohtan),** WS. **dīere, līehtan** (§ **138**).

CHAPTER VI

THE OLD ENGLISH DEVELOPMENT OF THE PRIMITIVE GERMANIC VOWELS OF UNACCENTED SYLLABLES

§ **211.** Before formulating the laws which govern the treatment of the vowels in final syllables, it will be useful to state here the laws relating to the treatment of final consonants in prehistoric OE. :—

(1) Final **-m** became **-n,** and then it, as also Indg. final **-n,** disappeared already in primitive Germanic. When

the vowel which thus became final was short, it had the same further development as if it had been originally final, as **geoc**, Goth. **juk**, Lat. **jugum**, Gr. ζυγόν, Indg. ***jugóm**, *yoke*; acc. sing. OE. Goth. **wulf**, Lat. **lupum**, Gr. λύκον, Indg. ***wlqom**, *wolf*; **giest**, Goth. **gast**, from ***gastim**, *guest*, cp. Lat. **turrim**, *tower*; **fōt**, Goth. **fōtu**, from ***fōtun**, cp. Lat. **pedem**, Gr. πόδα (§ 34), *foot*; gen. pl. **daga** from ***đagōn**, older **-ōm**, *of days*, cp. Gr. θεῶν, *of gods*; **fōta**, *of feet*; and similarly in the gen. plural of the other vocalic and consonantal stems; pret. sing. **nerede**, Goth. **nasida**, prim. Germanic ***naziđōn**, older **-ōm**, *I saved*; nom. sing. of feminine and neuter **n**-stems, as **tunge**, Goth. **tuggō**, *tongue*; **ēage**, Goth. **áugō**, *eye*, original ending **-ōn**.

(2) The Indg. final explosives disappeared in prim. Germanic, except after a short accented vowel, as pres. subj. **bere**, Goth. **baírái**, from an original form ***bheroĩt**, *he may bear*; **bǣrun**, Goth. **bērun**, *they bore*, original ending **-nt** with vocalic **n** (§ 85); **mōna**, Goth. **mēna**, from an original form ***mēnōt**, *moon*; but **þæt**, *that, the*, Indg. ***tod**; **hwæt** = Lat. **quod**, *what*; **æt** = Lat. **ad**, *at*.

(3) Final **-z**, which arose from Indg. **-s** by Verner's law (§ 252), disappeared in the West Germanic languages, as nom. sing. **dæg**, OS. **dag**, OHG. **tag**, beside Goth. **dags**, O.Icel. **dagr**, *day*, all from a prim. Germanic form ***đagaz**, *day*; and similarly in the nom. sing. of masc. and feminine **i**- and **u**-stems; in the gen. singular of **ō**-, and consonantal stems; in the nom. and acc. plural of masc. and feminine nouns; in the dat. plural of all nouns, adjectives, and pronouns; &c.

NOTE.—It is difficult to account for the **-s** in the nom. plural of **a**-stems in OE. and OS., as **dagas**, OS. **dagos**, *days*, see § 334.

(4) Indg. final **-r** remained, as **fæder**, Goth. **fadar**, Lat. **pater**, Gr. πατήρ, *father*; **mōdor**, Lat. **māter**, Gr. Dor. μάτηρ, *mother*.

§ **212.** (1) **a** (= Indg. **a** and **o**), which was originally final or became final in prim. Germanic through the loss of a following consonant, disappeared in dissyllabic and polysyllabic forms already in primitive OE., as **wāt,** Goth. **wáit,** Gr. οἶδα, *I know*; **wāst,** Goth. **wáist,** Gr. οἶσθα, *thou knowest*; pret. first pers. singular of strong verbs, as **band,** *I bound*; **bær,** *I bore,* **sæt,** *I sat,* prim. Germanic ***þanđa,** ***þara,** ***sata,** from older ***bhondha,** ***bhora,** ***soda**; nom. sing. **wulf** from ***wulfaz** = Gr. λύκος, *wolf*; acc. **wulf** from ***wulfan** = Gr. λύκον; nom. acc. neut. **geoc** from ***jukan** = Gr. ζυγόν, Lat. **jugum,** *yoke*; gen. sing. **dæges** from ***đagesa,** older **-o,** *of a day*; **beran** from ***beranan** = Indg. ***bheronom,** *to bear*; pp. **boren** from ***burenaz,** *borne*; pp. **genered** from ***-naziđaz,** *saved*; **cyning** from ***kuniŋgas,** *king*.

§ **213.** (2) Original final **e** disappeared in primitive OE. without leaving any trace, but when the **e** was originally followed by a consonant it became **i** in prim. Germanic, and then underwent the same further development in OE. as original **i** (see below), as **wāt,** Goth. **wáit** = Gr. οἶδε, *he knows*; pret. third pers. singular of strong verbs, as **band,** *he bound*; **bær,** *he bore*; **sat,** *he sat,* prim. Germanic ***þanđe,** ***þare,** ***sate,** from older ***bhondhe,** ***bhore,** ***sode**; imperative **ber** from ***þere** = Gr. φέρε, *bear thou*; **nim** from ***neme,** *take thou* = Gr. νέμε, *distribute thou*; voc. singular **wulf** from ***wulfe** = Gr. λύκε, Lat. **lupe,** *wolf*; **fīf,** Goth. **fimf** = Gr. πέντε, Indg. ***peŋqe,** *five*; **mec,** Goth. **mik,** cp. Gr. ἐμέγε, *me*. But pl. nom. **fēt, fēt** from ***fōtiz** older **-ez,** cp. Gr. πόδες, Lat. **pedes,** *feet*; **guman** from ***gumaniz,** cp. Lat. **homines,** *men*; **hnyte** from ***χnutiz,** *nuts*.

§ **214.** (3) Final long vowels, inherited from prim. Germanic, became shortened already in prim. OE. :—

-ō (= Indg. **ō** and **ā**) became **u,** as **beru** from ***þerō** = Gr. φέρω, *I bear*; nom. singular **giefu** from ***ǥeþō,** Indg. ***ghebhā,** *gift,* cp. Gr. χώρᾱ, *land*; nom. acc. neut. plural

geocu from ***jukō**, older ***jukā** = O.Lat. **jugā**, Indg. ***juǥā**, *yokes*.

-ī became **-i**, later **-e**, as pres. subj. third pers. singular **wile**, *he will* = O.Lat. **velīt**; imper. second pers. singular **nere**, Goth. **nasei**, OHG. **neri**, from ***nazī**, older ***nazij(i)**, Indg. ***noséje**, *save thou*.

§ **215.** (4) Short **u** and **i**, which were originally final or became final through the loss of a consonant, disappeared in trisyllabic and polysyllabic forms. They, as well as the **u** and **i**, which arose from the shortening of **ō** and **ī**, disappeared also in dissyllabic forms when the first syllable was long, but remained when the first syllable was short. The regular operation of this law was often disturbed by analogical formations.

Regular forms were: nom. sing. **giest** = Goth. **gasts**, from ***ǥastiz**, *guest* = Lat. **hostis**, *stranger, enemy*; acc. **giest** = Goth. **gast**, from ***ǥastin** = Lat. ***hostim**; dat. sing. of consonantal stems, as **fœt**, **fēt** (nom. **fōt**, *foot*) from ***fōti**, cp. Gr. ποδί; dat. plural of nouns, as **dagum** (nom. **dæg**, *day*) from ***đaǥomiz**; **giefum** (nom. **giefu**, *gift*) from ***ǥeþōmiz**; **hīer** = Goth. **háusei**, from ***χauzī**, *hear thou*; **sēc** = Goth. **sōkei**, *seek thou*; **bend** = Goth. **bandi**, from ***þanđī**, *band*; in the second and third pers. singular and third pers. plural of the pres. indicative, as prim. Germanic ***nimiz**, *thou takest*; ***nimiđ**, *he takes*; ***nemanđ**, *they take*, from older ***nemesi**, ***nemeti**, ***nemonti** (on the OE. endings of these forms, see § **476**); sing. nom. **hand** = Goth. **handus**, *hand*; acc. **hand** = Goth. **handu**; acc. singular of consonantal stems, as **fōt** = Goth. **fōtu**, *foot*; **fæder** from ***fađerun**, *father*; **guman** from ***ǥumanun**, *man*; nom. **lār** from ***lāru**, older ***laizō**, *lore, teaching*; neut. pl. **word** from ***wordu**, older ***wurđō**, *words*; nom. acc. pl. neuter **yfel** from ***uþilu**, older ***uþilō**, *evil*; nom. acc. singular **wini**, **wine** (OHG. **wini**), from ***winiz**, ***winin**, *friend*; **mere** (OHG. **meri**), from ***mari**, *lake*; nom. plural **wine**

(OHG. **wini**), from ***winīz**, older **-ij(i)z**, **-ejes**, *friends*; imperative **sete** from ***satī**, Indg ***sodeje**, *set thou*; pres. subj. **scyle** from older ***skulī**, *shall*; sing. nom. **sunu** = Goth. **sunus**, *son*; acc. **sunu** = Goth. **sunu**; **feola** (**fela**) = Goth. **filu**, *much*; neut. pl. **fatu**, from ***fatō**, *vats*; **beru** (**beoru**) from ***þerō**, *I bear*. Then after the analogy of these and similar forms were made **feoh** for ***feohu**, *money* = Goth. **faíhu**, OHG. **fihu**, Lat. **pecu**, *cattle*; **bindu**, *I bind*, **helpu**, *I help*, **cēosu**, *I choose*, for ***bind**, ***help**, ***cēos**. The final **-u** from older **-w** (§ **265**) also disappeared after long stem-syllables, as **gād**, Goth. **gáidw**, *want, lack*; **ā**, Goth. **áiw**, *ever*; **hrā**, Goth. **hráiw**, *corpse*; but remained after short stem-syllables, as **bealu**, *evil, calamity*, **bearu**, *grove*, beside gen. **bealwes**, **bearwes**.

NOTE.—Final **i**, which remained in the oldest period of the language, regularly became **e** in the seventh century. And final **u** became **o** at an early period, and then in late OE. **a**, whence forms like nom. acc. **sunu**, **suno**, **suna**, *son*; pl. **fatu**, **fato**, **fata**, *vats*.

§ **216**. In trisyllabic forms final **-u**, which arose from prim. Germanic **-ō**, disappeared after a long medial syllable. It also disappeared when the stem and medial syllable were short, but remained when the stem-syllable was long and the medial syllable short, as **leornung** from ***lirnungu**, *learning*; **byden** from ***budinu**, older **buðīnō**, *tub*; pl. **reced** from ***rakidu**, older ***rakiðō**, *halls, palaces*; neut. pl. **yfel** from ***uþilu**, older ***uþilō**, *evil*; but fem. nom. sing. **hāligu**, *holy*, **hēafodu**, *heads*, **nīetenu**, *animals*.

§ **217**. (5) The Indg. long diphthongs **-āi**, **-ōi**, **-ōu** became shortened to **-ai**, **-au** in prim. Germanic, and then underwent the same further changes as old **-ai**, **-au**, that is, they became **-ǣ**, **-ō** in West Germanic.

Later than the shortening mentioned in § **214** occurred the shortening which was undergone in dissyllabic and polysyllabic words by the long vowel, after which an

-n or **-z** had disappeared, and by the **-ǣ** and **-ō** from older **-ai** and **-au**, which were either already final in prim. Germanic, or had become so after the loss of **-z**. In this case a distinction must be made according as the long vowel originally had the 'slurred' (circumflex) or 'broken' (acute) accent (§ 9). **-ō̃** with the circumflex accent became **-e** (older **æ**) after the loss of **-z**, but **-a** after the loss of **-n**. **-ō** with the acute accent became **-e** (older **æ**) after the loss of **-n**. The **-ǣ** and **-ō** from older **-ai** and **-au** became **-e** (older **æ**) and **-a**. All these shortenings took place in prehistoric Old English. Examples are :—gen. sing. and nom. plural **gefe** (Anglian) from ***ȝeþō̃z** = Goth. **gibōs**, nom. sing. **giefu** (WS.), *gift*; gen. plural **daga** from ***đaȝō̃n**, older **-ōm**, *of days*; **fōta** from ***fōtō̃n**, *of feet*, cp. Gr. θεῶν, *of gods*; and similarly in the gen. plural of other vocalic and consonantal stems; nom. singular of masculine **n**-stems, as **guma** from ***ȝumō̃(n)**, *man*; acc. singular **giefe** from ***ȝeþōn**, older **-ōm**, *gift*, cp. Gr. χώρᾱν, *land*; nom. singular of feminine and neuter **n**-stems, as **tunge** from ***tuŋȝōn** = Goth. **tuggō**, *tongue*; **ēage** from ***auȝōn** = Goth. **áugō**, *eye*; **nerede** from ***naziđōn**, older **-ōm**, *I saved*; **fore**, *before* = Gr. παραί, *near*; dat. sing. **dæge** from ***đaȝai**, older **-ŏi**, *to a day*, cp. Gr. locative οἴκοι, *at home*, dat. λύκῳ, *to a wolf*; dat. sing. **giefe** = Goth. **gibái**, Indg. ***ghebhāi**, *to a gift*, cp. Gr. dat. χώρᾳ for *χώραι, *to land*; fem. dat. sing. **blindre** from ***þlinđizai**, *blind*; masc. nom. plural **blinde** = Goth. **blindái**, *blind*; **bere** = Goth. **baírái**, Gr. φέροι, *he may bear*; **eahta** = Goth. **ahtáu**, from an original form ***oktōu**, *eight*; **eþþa** = Goth. **aíþþáu**, *or*; gen. singular **suna** = Goth. **sunáus**, *of a son*.

§ **218.** After the operation of the sound-laws described in §§ **212–17**, many vowels, which originally stood in medial syllables, came to stand in final syllables in prehistoric OE. These vowels underwent various changes.

1. Indg. **o** remained longer in unaccented syllables than

in accented syllables in prim. Germanic. It became **a** during the prim. Germanic period except (1) when followed by an **m** which remained in historic times, and (2) when the following syllable originally contained an **u**. In these cases the **o** became **u** in OE., as dat. plural **dagum** beside Goth. **dagam,** prim. Germanic ***đaȝomiz,** *to days*; acc. sing. **brōþur** (later **·or, ·ar**), from ***þrōþorun,** *brother* = Gr. φράτορα (§ **34**), *member of a clan*; acc. pl. **brōþur** from ***þrōþorunz.** Prim. Germanic **a** remained before **n,** but became **e** (older **æ**) in other cases, as inf. **beran** from ***þeranan,** Indg. ***bheronom,** *to bear*; acc. sing. of masc. and feminine **n**-stems, as **guman,** *man*; **tungan,** *tongue,* from **·anun,** older **·onm** (with vocalic **m**); nom. plural **guman, tungan,** from **·aniz,** older **·ones**; but **huneg** older **hunæg** (OHG. **honag**), *honey.*

2. Indg. **e** remained in OE. when originally not followed by a palatal vowel in the next syllable, as **hwæþer** = Gr. πότερος, *whether, which of two*; gen. sing. **dæges** from ***đaȝesa,** older **·o,** *of a day*; pp. **bunden** from ***þunđenaz,** Indg. ***bhndhenos,** *bound*; **ōþer** from ***anþeraz,** *other.* But when **e** was originally followed by a palatal vowel it became **i** already in prim. Germanic, see below.

3. Prim. Germanic **i** remained in OE. before palatal consonants, as **englisc,** *English*; **hefig,** *heavy*; **ūsic,** *us.* It also remained in other cases in the oldest period of the language, but became **e** in the seventh century (see § **215,** Note), as pp. **genered** from ***·naziđaz,** *saved*; **nimes(t),** OHG. **nimis,** *thou takest,* Indg. ***nemesi**; **nimeþ,** OHG. **nimit,** *he takes,* Indg. ***nemeti.** The **e** in the second and third pers. singular was mostly syncopated in WS. and Ken., but generally remained in Anglian (see § **476**).

4. Prim. Germanic **u** always remained before a following **m,** but in other cases it became **o** already at an early period, and in late OE. also **a** (see § **215,** Note), as dat. plural **sunum,** *to sons*; **fōtum,** *to feet,* prim. Germanic

-umiz; pret. pl. indicative **bǣrun, -on,** *they bore*; **neredun, -on,** *they saved.*

5. All long vowels underwent shortening already in prehistoric Old English:—

ǣ > e, as **fæder,** cp. Gr. πατήρ, *father*; **neredes** (older **-dæs**) from ***naziđǣs,** cp. Goth. **nasidēs,** *thou didst save.*

ī > i, later **e,** except before palatal consonants, as **gylden** (OHG. **guldīn**) from ***gulþīnaz; mægden** = OHG. **magatīn,** *maiden*; subj. pret. plural **bǣren** = Goth. **bēreina,** OHG. **bārīn,** *they might bear*; but **mihtig** = Goth. **mahteigs,** OHG. **mahtīg,** *mighty*; **gōdlic,** *goodly,* beside the stressed form **gelīc,** *like.*

ō > u, later **o, a** (cp. § **215,** Note), but **u** always remained before a following **m,** as **huntoþ, -aþ,** from ***χuntōþuz,** *hunting*; **heardost,** *hardest,* **lēofost,** *dearest,* prim. Germanic superlative suffix **-ōst-**; **sealfas(t)** = Goth. **salbōs,** *thou anointest*; **sealfaþ** = Goth. **salbōþ,** *he anoints*; pret. sing. **sealfude, -ode, -ade** = Goth. **salbōda,** *I anointed*; pp. **gesealfud, -od, -ad** = Goth. **salbōþs**; but always **u** in the dat. pl. **giefum** = Goth. **gibōm,** *to gifts*; **tungum** = Goth. **tuggōm,** *to tongues.* The combination **-ōj-** was weakened to **-i-** (through the intermediate stages **-ēj-, -ej-, -ij-**), as in the inf. of the second class of weak verbs: **lufian,** *to love*; **macian,** *to make*; **sealfian,** *to anoint.* The prim. OE. ending **-ōþ** from older **-onþ** (see § **61**), **-anþ, -anþi,** Indg. **-onti,** was regularly weakened to **-aþ,** as **beraþ** = Gr. Dor. φέροντι, *they bear.*

ū > u (later **o, a**). In this case the **ū** arose in prim. OE. from the loss of **n** before a voiceless spirant (§ **286**). Examples are: **fracuþ, -oþ,** from ***frakunþaz,** *wicked* = Goth. **frakunþs,** *despised*; **duguþ** from ***đuȝunþ-** = OHG. **tugunt,** *valour, strength*; **geoguþ** from ***juȝunþ-** = OHG. **jugunt,** *youth.*

§ **219.** If a nasal or a liquid, preceded by a mute consonant, came to stand finally after the loss of a vowel

(§ **212**), it became vocalic, and then a new vowel was generated before it in prehistoric OE. just as was the case in prehistoric OS. and OHG. The vowel thus generated was generally **e** when the preceding vowel was palatal, but **o** (**u**), later also **e**, when the preceding vowel was guttural, as nom. **efen** from ***eƀnaz**, cp. Goth. **ibns**, *even*; nom. acc. **æcer** from ***akr**, older ***akraz**, ***akran**, cp. Goth. **akrs**, **akr**, *field*; nom. acc. **fugul**, **-ol**, from ***fugl**, older ***foȝlaz**, ***foȝlan**, cp. Goth. **fugls**, **fugl**, *bird, fowl*; nom. acc. **māþum** from ***maiþm**, older ***maiþmaz**, ***maiþman**, cp. Goth. **máiþms**, **máiþm**, *gift*. In the oldest period of the language forms with and without the new vowel often existed side by side. The new vowel occurred most frequently before **r**. Vocalic **l** was common especially after dentals, and vocalic **m** and **n** generally occurred after a short syllable. The forms with vocalic **l**, **m**, **n**, **r** in the nom. acc. singular were due to levelling out the stem-form of the inflected cases. Thus regular forms were: nom. **segel**, *sail*; **māþum**, *gift*; **bēacen**, *sign, beacon*; **efen**, *even*; **æcer**, *field*; **þunor**, *thunder*; gen. **segles**, **māþmes**, **bēacnes**, **efnes**, **æcres**, **þunres**. Then from the latter were formed new nominatives **segl**, **māþm**, **bēacn**, **efn**; and from the former new genitives **æceres**, **þunores**. Examples are: **æppel**, **æpl**, *apple*; **hūsul**, **hūsel**, **hūsl**, *Eucharist*, cp. Goth. **hunsl**, *sacrifice*; **nǣdl** (Goth. **nēþla**), *needle*; **nægl**, *nail*; **setl** (Goth. **sitls**), *seat*; **tempel**, **templ** (Lat. **templum**), *temple*; **tungul**, **-ol**, **-el**, *star*. **bōsm**, *bosom*; **botm**, *bottom*; **ǣþm**, *breath*; **þrosm**, *smoke*; **wæstum**, **-em**, **wæstm**, *growth*. **hræfn**, *raven*; **regn** (Goth. **rign**), *rain*; **stefn**, *voice*; **tācen**, **tācn** (Goth. **táikns**), *token*; **þegen**, **þegn**, *retainer*; **wægn**, *wagon*. **ātr**, **ātor**, *poison*; **fæger** (Goth. **fagrs**), *fair, beautiful*; **finger** (Goth. **figgrs**), *finger*; **hlūtor** (Goth. **hlūtrs**), *pure, clear*; **snotor**, *wise*; **winter** (Goth. **wintrus**), *winter*; **wundor**, *wonder*.

§ **220.** In OE., especially in the later period, a svarabhakti vowel was often developed between **r** or **l**+**c**, **g**, or **h**; and between **r**, **l**, **d**, or **t**+**w**. In the former case the quality of the vowel thus developed regulated itself after the quality of the stem-vowel. In the latter case it fluctuated between **u** (**o**) and **e**, rarely **a**. The development of a similar vowel in these consonant combinations also took place in OS. and OHG. Examples are: nom. sing. **burug**, **buruh** (OS. OHG. **burug**) beside **burg**, **burh** (OS. OHG. **burg**), *city*; but dat. sing. and nom. plural **byrig** beside **byrg**; **byriga** beside **byrga**, *bail, surety*; **fyligan** beside **fylgan**, *to follow*; **myrigþ** beside **myrgþ**, *mirth*; **styric** beside **styrc**, *calf*, cp. modern northern dial. **stərək** beside **stōk**; **woruhte**, **worohte** (OHG. **worahta**) beside **worhte** (OHG. **worhta**), *he worked*. **beadu**, **-o**, *battle*, gen. dat. **beaduwe**, **-owe** beside **beadwe**; **bealu**, *evil*, gen. **bealuwes**, **-owes** beside **bealwes**; **bearu**, *grove*, **bearuwes**, **-owes** beside **bearwes**; **frætuwe**, **-ewe** beside **frætwe**, *trappings*; **gearu**, *ready*, gen. **gearuwes** (OHG. **garawes**), **-owes**, **-ewes** beside **gearwes**; **gearuwe** (OHG. **garawa**), **-ewe** beside **gearwe** (OHG. **garwa**), *yarrow*; **geolu**, *yellow*, gen. **geoluwes**, **-owes** beside **geolwes**; **melu**, **meolu**, *meal, flour*, gen. **meluwes** (OHG. **melawes**), **-owes**, **-ewes** beside **melwes** (OHG. **melwes**); **nearu**, *narrow*, gen. **nearuwes**, **-owes**, **-ewes** beside **nearwes**; and similarly with several other words.

§ **221.** Original short medial vowels in open syllables regularly remained in trisyllabic forms when the stem-syllable was short, as **æþele**, *noble*; gen. sing. **heofones**, **metodes**, **nacodes**, **rodores**, **stapoles**, **wæteres**, beside nom. **heofon**, *heaven*; **metod**, *creator*; **nacod**, *naked*; **rodor**, *sky*; **stapol**, *pillar*; **wæter**, *water*; gen. dat. sing. **idese** beside nom. **ides**, *woman*; pret. **fremedest** from ***framiđæs**, *thou didst perform*; **neredest** from ***naziđæs**, *thou didst save*. On the syncope of **i** after prim. Germanic

short stems in the preterite and past participle of weak verbs, see § **534**.

They also remained in closed syllables irrespectively as to whether the stem-syllable was long or short, as gen. sing. **cyninges, fǣtelses, hengestes, wēstennes,** beside nom. **cyning,** *king*; **fǣtels,** *tub*; **hengest,** *stallion*; **wēsten,** *desert*; **fāgettan,** *to change colour*; pres. participle **nimende,** *taking*; superlatives **ieldesta,** *oldest*; **lengesta,** *longest.* It is difficult to account for the syncope in **hīehsta,** *highest*; and **nīehsta,** *nearest.*

They also remained after consonant combinations, when preceded by a closed stem-syllable, or a stem-syllable containing a long diphthong or vowel, as pret. **hyngrede, timbrede, dīeglede, frēfrede,** beside inf. **hyngran,** *to hunger,* **timbran,** *to build,* **dīeglan,** *to conceal,* **frēfran,** *to comfort*; dat. pl. **syndrigum** beside nom. sing. **syndrig,** *separate.*

They regularly disappeared in open syllables when the stem-syllable was long, as gen. sing. **dīegles, engles, hālges, hēafdes, ōþres,** beside nom. **dīegol,** *secret*; **engel,** *angel*; **hālig,** *holy*; **hēafod,** *head*; **ōþer,** *other*; **hālgian,** *to make holy*; **strengþu** from ***straŋgiþō** (OHG. **strengida**), *strength*; **ieldra** (Goth. **alþiza**), *older*; gen. dat. sing. **frōfre, mōnþe, sāwle,** beside nom. **frōfor,** *consolation*; **mōnaþ,** *month*; **sāwol,** *soul*; **dǣldest** (Goth. **dáilidēs**), *thou didst divide*; **hīerdest** (Goth. **háusidēs**), *thou heardest.*

§ **222.** Short medial guttural vowels, followed by a guttural vowel in the next syllable, often became palatal by dissimilation, as **hafela,** *head,* beside **hafola**; **nafela,** *navel,* beside **nafola**; **gaderian** from ***gađurōjan,** *to gather*; pl. nom. **heofenas,** gen. **heofena,** dat. **heofenum,** beside sing. gen. **heofones,** dat. **heofone,** nom. **heofon,** *heaven*; pl. nom. **roderas,** gen. **rodera,** dat. **roderum,** beside sing. gen. **rodores,** dat. **rodore,** nom. **rodor,** *firmament*; pl. nom. **stapelas,** gen. **stapela,** dat. **stapelum,** beside sing. gen. **stapoles,** dat. **stapole,** nom. **stapol,** *pillar.* The inter-

change between **e** and **o** in forms like **sealfedon** (OHG. **salbōtun**), *they anointed*, beside **sealfode** (OHG. **salbōta**), *he anointed*, is probably due to the same cause.

§ **223.** In prim. OE. polysyllabic forms the second medial short vowel disappeared when it stood in an open syllable, but remained when it stood in a closed syllable, as acc. sing. masc. **ōþerne** from ***anþeranō(n)**, *other*; and similarly **glædne**, *glad*; **gōdne**, *good*; **hāligne**, *holy*; &c.; dat. fem. singular **ōþerre** from ***anþerizai**; and similarly **glædre, gōdre, hāligre**; gen. plural **ōþerra**, prim. Germanic ***anþeraizõ(n)**, older **-õm**; and similarly **gōdra, hāligra.** But having a secondary accent in a closed syllable, the vowel regularly remained, as nom. plural **gædelingas**, *companions*; dat. singular **gaderunge**, *to an assembly*; **innemesta**, *inmost.*

NOTE.—1. There are many exceptions to the above sound-laws, which are due to analogical formations. Thus forms like masc. and neut. gen. singular **micles**, dat. **miclum**, *great*; **yfles, yflum**, beside **yfeles, yfelum**, *evil*; gen. pl. **glædra**, *glad*, were made on analogy with forms having a long stem-syllable. And forms like gen. singular **dēofoles** (nom. **dēofol**, *devil*), **ēþeles** (nom. **ēþel**, *native land*), **hāliges**, *holy*, beside older **dēofles, ēþles, hālges**, were made on analogy with forms having a short stem-syllable.

2. In late OE. syncope often took place after short stems, and sometimes in closed syllables, as **betra**, *better*; **circe**, *church*; **fægnian**, *to rejoice*, **gadrian**, *to gather*, beside older **betera, cirice, fægenian, gaderian**; **betsta**, *best*; **winstre**, *left* (*hand*), beside older **betesta, winestre.**

3. Original medial long vowels, which were shortened at an early period, were syncopated in trisyllabic forms in OE., but remained when the shortening took place at a later period, as dat. singular **mōnþe** beside **mōnaþ** (Goth. **mēnōþs**), *month*; but **lōcodest** from ***lōkōđās**, *thou didst look.*

CHAPTER VII

ABLAUT (VOWEL GRADATION)

§ **224.** By ablaut is meant the gradation of vowels both in stem and suffix, which was caused by the primitive Indo-Germanic system of accentuation. See § **9.**

The vowels vary within certain series of related vowels, called ablaut-series. In OE., to which this chapter will be chiefly confined, there are six such series, which appear most clearly in the stem-forms of strong verbs. Four stem-forms are to be distinguished in an OE. strong verb which has vowel gradation as the characteristic mark of its different stems:—(1) The present stem, to which belong all the forms of the present, (2) the stem of the first or third person singular of the preterite indicative, (3) the stem of the preterite plural, to which belong the second pers. pret. singular, and the whole of the pret. subjunctive, (4) the stem of the past participle.

By arranging the vowels according to these four stems we arrive at the following system:—

	i.	ii.	iii.	iv.
I.	**ī**	**ā**	**i**	**i**
II.	**ēo**	**ēa**	**u**	**o**
III.	**i, e**	**a**	**u**	**u, o**
IV.	**e**	**æ**	**ǣ**	**o**
V.	**e**	**æ**	**ǣ**	**e**
VI.	**a**	**ō**	**ō**	**æ (a)**

NOTE.– 1. The six series as given above represent the simple vowels and diphthongs when uninfluenced by neighbouring sounds. For the changes caused by umlaut and the influence of consonants, see the phonology, especially §§ **47–52,** and the various classes of strong verbs, §§ **490–519.**

2. On the difference in Series III between **i** and **e**, see § **41**; and between **u** and **o**, § **43.**

3. Strong verbs belonging to Series II have **īe** from older **iu** (§ **138**) in the second and third pers. singular of the pres. indicative; and strong verbs belonging to Series III–V with **e** in the infinitive have **i** in the second and third pers. singular of the pres. indicative (§ **41**).

§ **225.** But although the series of vowels is seen most clearly in the stem-forms of strong verbs, the learner must not assume that ablaut occurs in strong verbs only. Every *syllable* of every word of whatever part of speech contains some form of ablaut. As for example the sonantal elements in the following stem-syllables stand in ablaut relation to each other:—

līþan, *to go,* **līþend,** *sailor*: **lād,** *way, course*: **lida,** *sailor*; **lār,** *learning*: **liornung** (**leornung**), *learning*; **snīþan,** *to cut*: **snǣd** from ***snādi-,** *morsel, slice*: **snide,** *incision*; **wītega,** *prophet*: **wāt,** *he knows*: **witan,** *to know,* **wita,** *wise man,* **gewit,** *intelligence.*

bēodan, *to command, order*: **gebod,** *command, precept,* **bydel** from ***budil,** *messenger*; **flēon,** *to flee*: **flēam,** *flight*: **flyht** from ***fluhti-,** *flight*; **nēotan,** *to use*: **genēat,** *companion*: **notu,** *use,* **nytt** (Germanic stem-form ***nutja-**), *useful*; **tēon,** *to draw, lead*: **tēam,** *progeny*: **here-toga,** *army leader, general.*

bindan, *to bind*: **bend** from ***bandi-,** *band*; **drincan,** *to drink*: **drenc** from ***dranki-,** *drink*: **druncen,** *drunk*; **sweltan,** *to die*: **swylt** from ***swulti-,** *death*; **weorþan** from ***werþan,** *to become*: **wyrd** from ***wurdi-,** *fate.*

beran, *to bear*: **bǣr,** *bier*: **ge-byrd** from ***gi-burdi-,** *birth,* **byre** from ***buri-,** *son*; **cwelan,** *to die*: **cwalu,** *killing*; **stelan,** *to steal*: **stalu,** *theft*: **stulor,** *stealthy.*

giefan, *to give,* **giefa** from ***geþa,** *giver,* **gift** from ***gefti-,** *price of wife*: **gafol,** *tribute*; **cweþan,** *to say*: **cwide,** prim. Germanic ***kweđi-,** *speech*; **sprecan,** *to speak*: **sprǣc,** *speech.*

calan, *to be cold*: **cōl,** *cool*; **faran,** *to go, travel,* **fierd**

from ***fardi·**, *army*: **fōr**, *journey*, **gefēra**, prim. Germanic *-**fōrjō̄**, *companion*; **stede** from ***stadi**, *place*: **stōd**, *herd of horses*. See § **562**.

Examples of ablaut relation in other than stem-syllables are:—

Goth. nom. pl. **anstei·s**, *favours*: gen. sing. **anstái·s**: acc. pl. **ansti·ns**; Goth. nom. pl. **sunju·s** from an original form ***suneu·es**, *sons*: gen. sing. **sunáu·s**: acc. pl. **sunu·ns**; Gr. φέρο·μεν, *we bear*: φέρε·τε, *ye bear* = Goth. **baíra·m**, **baíri·þ**.

§ **226**. In this paragraph will be given the prim. Germanic and Gothic equivalents of the above six ablaut-series, with one or two illustrations from OE. For further examples see the various classes of strong verbs, §§ **490–510**.

I.

Prim. Germ.	ī	ai	i	i
Gothic	ei	ái	i	i
OE.	**bītan**, *to bite*	**bāt**	**biton**	**biten**
	līþan, *to go*	**lāþ**	**lidon**	**liden**

NOTE.—Cp. the parallel Greek series πείθω : πέποιθα : ἔπιθον.

II.

Prim. Germ.	eu	au	u	o
Gothic	iu	áu	u	u
OE.	**bēodan**, *to offer*	**bēad**	**budon**	**boden**
	cēosan, *to choose*	**cēas**	**curon**	**coren**

NOTE.—Cp. the parallel Greek series ἑλεύ(θ)σομαι (fut.): εἰλήλουθα : ἤλυθον.

III.

Prim. Germ.	e, i	a	u	u, o
Gothic	i	a	u	u
OE.	**helpan**, *to help*	**healp**	**hulpon**	**holpen**
	weorþan, *to become*	**wearþ**	**wurdon**	**worden**
	bindan, *to bind*	**band**	**bundon**	**bunden**

NOTE.—1. To this series belong all strong verbs having a medial nasal or liquid + consonant, and a few others in which the vowel is followed by two consonants other than a nasal or liquid + consonant.

2. On the forms **healp**, **wearþ** see § **66**, and on **weorþan** see § **85**.

3. Cp. the parallel Greek series δέρκομαι : δέδορκα : ἔδρακον ; πέμπω : πέπομφα.

IV.

Prim. Germ.		e	a	ǣ	o
	Gothic	i	a	ē	u
	OE.	**beran,** *to bear*	**bær**	**bǣron**	**boren**
		stelan, *to steal*	**stæl**	**stǣlon**	**stolen**

NOTE.—1. To this series belong all strong verbs whose stems end in a single liquid or nasal.

2. Cp. the parallel Greek series μένω : μονή : μί-μνω ; δέρω : δορά : δε-δαρ-μένος.

V.

Prim. Germ.		e	a	ǣ	e
	Gothic	i	a	ē	i
	OE.	**metan,** *to measure*	**mæt**	**mǣton**	**meten**
		cweþan, *to say*	**cwæþ**	**cwǣdon**	**cweden**

NOTE.—1. To this class belong all strong verbs whose stems end in a single consonant other than a liquid or a nasal.

2. Cp. the parallel Greek series πέτομαι : πότμος : ἐ-πτ-όμην ; τρέπω : τέ-τροφα : τραπέσθαι.

VI.

Prim. Germ.		a	ō	ō	a
	Gothic	a	ō	ō	a
	OE.	**faran,** *to go*	**fōr**	**fōron**	**færen, faren**

§ **227.** Class VII of strong verbs embracing the old reduplicated verbs (§§ **511–19**) has been omitted from the ablaut-series, because the exact relation in which the vowel of the present stands to that of the preterite has not yet